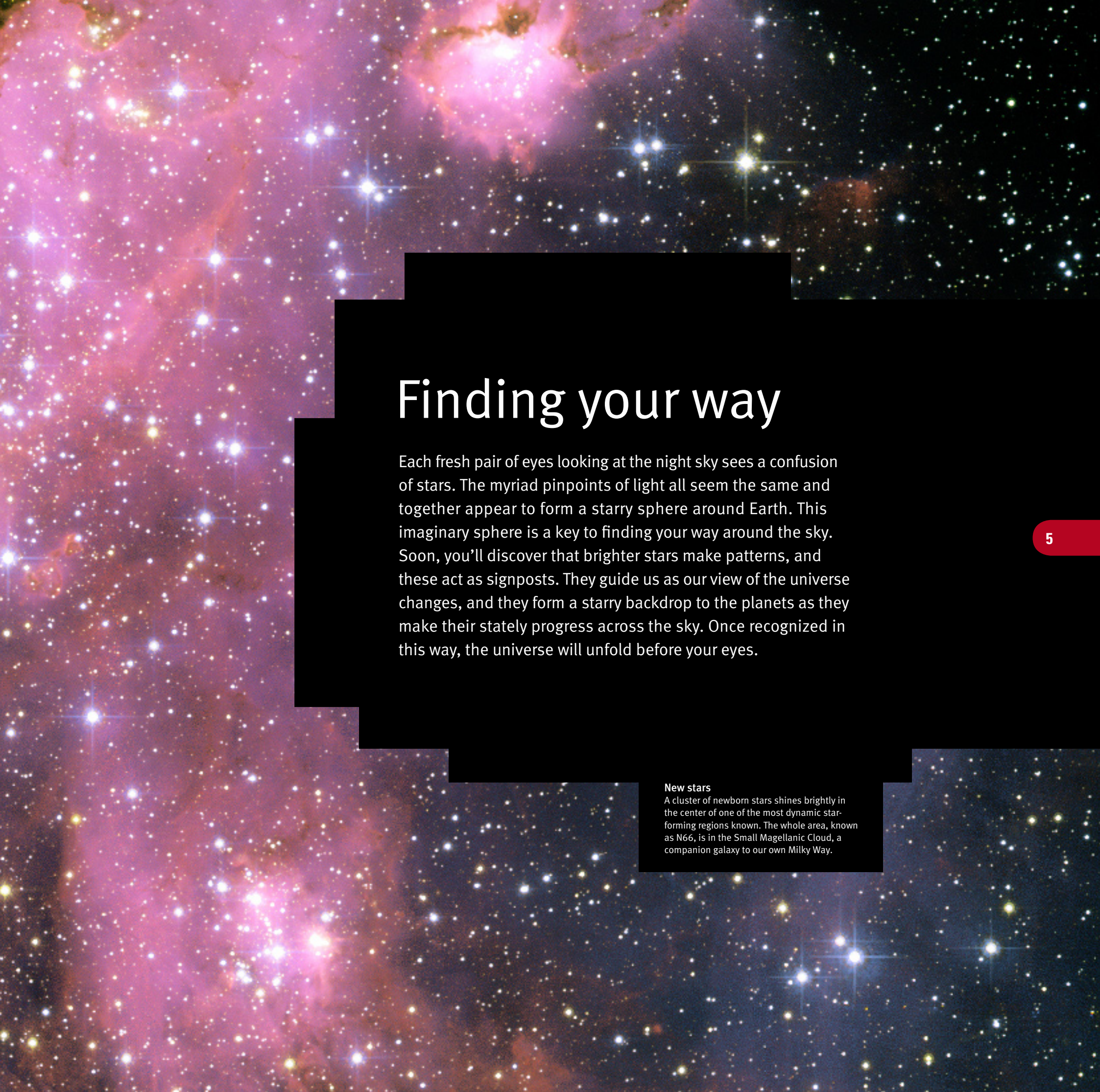




Finding your way

Each fresh pair of eyes looking at the night sky sees a confusion of stars. The myriad pinpoints of light all seem the same and together appear to form a starry sphere around Earth. This imaginary sphere is a key to finding your way around the sky. Soon, you'll discover that brighter stars make patterns, and these act as signposts. They guide us as our view of the universe changes, and they form a starry backdrop to the planets as they make their stately progress across the sky. Once recognized in this way, the universe will unfold before your eyes.

New stars

A cluster of newborn stars shines brightly in the center of one of the most dynamic star-forming regions known. The whole area, known as N66, is in the Small Magellanic Cloud, a companion galaxy to our own Milky Way.